The last-minute addition of paprika-flavored chorizo gives spice to this hearty soup. Keep the texture chunky by processing only briefly.

fennel soup with beans, thyme, and chorizo

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS PLUS SOAKING OVERNIGHT **COOK** 1 HOUR **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS WITHOUT THE CHORIZO

9oz (250g) dried haricot beans
1 tbsp sunflower or olive oil
1 Spanish onion, finely chopped
2 cloves garlic, crushed
1 head fennel, cored and finely chopped
2 tsp dried fennel seeds
1 tbsp finely chopped fresh parsley
2 tsp thyme leaves
salt and pepper
3½oz (100g) diced cubed chorizo

1 Soak the beans overnight in plenty of cold water, then drain and rinse. Put a heavy pot over medium heat. Add the oil, then the onion, and stir for 2 minutes. Add the garlic, fennel and fennel seeds, parsley, and half the thyme and cook for 3–5 minutes until slightly softened. Add the beans. Stir, pour in 2 quarts (2 liters) water and season lightly with salt and pepper.

2 Bring to a simmer and cook for 40 minutes, or until the beans are tender, skimming from time to time. Remove from the heat and let cool slightly. Transfer to a food processor or blender and process briefly until partly puréed. Return to the pot, adjust the seasoning, then gently reheat.

3 Meanwhile, place a small non-stick frying pan over medium-high heat and cook the chorizo for 2–3 minutes until crisp and colored, stirring frequently. Drain on a plate lined with paper towels.

4 Ladle the soup into bowls, add a little chorizo to each, and finish with a scattering of thyme. Serve immediately.